No ticket in the path

Why software factories need infrastructure factories, in ten minutes

Max Körbächer · infrastructure-factory.com · October 2026

THE SHIFT

Code got cheap. Environments still move through tickets.

75%

of new code at Google is AI-generated and approved by engineers.

Sundar Pichai, Google Cloud Next, April 2026

+441%

median time a change spends in review.

Faros AI, April 2026

−7%

main-branch throughput for the median team.

CircleCI, February 2026

Vendor-reported figures. Direction, not precision. Sources 4, 7 and 8 at infrastructure-factory.com/sources

Agents ship code in minutes. The environment it needs waits for a person to open a gate.

An Infrastructure Factory is

> A platform that turns intents from humans or agents into compliant, owned, observable, cost-attributed environments, with no ticket in the path.

Intent in: purpose, owner, data, lifetime. Environment out: already owned, compliant, observable and attributed to a cost center. The decisions that used to live in tickets are made once, at the contract.

THE TEST

Five lines. Do you have one?

1. Intent in, environment out. The product is a place to run things, not a list of resources.
2. No ticket in the path. Humans decide once, at the contract. Nobody decides per request.
3. Policy before provisioning. Allow or deny, with a reason the requester can act on.
4. Ownership and expiry by default. Cost center, compliance owner and on-call are inherited. Everything has a lifetime.
5. The factory measures itself. Lead time, zero-touch rate, time to owner and orphan rate, published to its customers.

Where are you?

0	1	2	3	4
Ticket desk	Automated fulfilment	Self-service portal	Contracted API	Infrastructure factory

A portal moves the form, not the wait. A contracted API removes the person from the request. The factory removes the person from the path and measures itself.

The full ladder: infrastructure-factory.com/infrastructure-factory/#ladder

Start with the sandboxes

Ephemeral sandboxes for coding agents are the first vending line. The demand exists already: sandboxes on Google Kubernetes Engine grew 16x in under five months after the Agent Sandbox preview.

A sandbox needs an identity, a lifetime and a policy, and nothing a human has to sign. Then preview environments per pull request. Then production.

Source 9 at infrastructure-factory.com/sources

Argue with it

infrastructure-factory.com · github.com/mkorbi/infrastructure-factory